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LONDON

OMEGA



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HOW CRYPTO CURRENCY IN MODERN BUSINESS WILL AFFECT THE AFRICAN MARKET

Financial technology (Fintech) is fast revolutionising the banking industry and the creation of digital-currencies based on block chain technology is an important evolution. Digital currencies exhibit properties similar to physical currencies, but allows for instantaneous transactions and borderless transfer-of-ownership. The main advantage of this can be seen in modern businesses that have to handle multiple transactions between their clients. The forerunners in the digital currency arena are numerous including Ethereum, Ripple Monetary, Litecoin etc. however, at the forefront remains Bitcoin. Bitcoin was created in 2009 by an individual using the alias, Satoshi Nakamoto. When Bitcoin first emerged, it held no value due to non-existent exchanges. However, once interest grew around the new crypto currency, Bitcoin saw its first significant rise - from \$0.008 to \$0.08 for 1 Bitcoin in July 2010 which represented a 1000% increase in value. There is a rather amusing tale whereby on May 22, 2010, a software developer, Laszlo Hanyecz bought two pizzas using 10,000 units of Bitcoin.

As those 10,000 Bitcoins are worth more than \$20 million you could say that this was a rather expensive pizza. On a serious note the weight of support and development behind Bitcoin is truly impressive considering the short timeline. As of November 2017, the currency stands at a record value of \$9642.59 for 1 Bitcoin with a dramatic increase in value this year. In Bitcoin, transactions are made with no intermediary medium - hence there are no banks involved nor any transaction fees. Therefore, for emerging markets and frontier markets, digital currencies represent a door opening whereby individuals without a bank account can buy / sell / exchange digital currencies or tokens via a smart contract which allows for a very efficient means of exchange. The phrase "smart contracts" was coined by Nick Szabo in 1996 and a smart contract is defined as a set of promises, laid out in digital form, including procedures within which the

groups perform on these promises. These smart contracts are agreements that can be enforced through a block-chain. The block-chain is used to create a contract that is automatically enforced in a decentralized fashion.

A very good example is when a user of a mobile phone network which offers a tokenised mechanism to exchange services (such as Yovo) between the users. The user will acquire Yo tokens through actions such as downloading apps. These tokens can then be used to reward or pay other users. Consider a real world example: Afua is an African designer of Luxury leather handbags and has amassed a number of Yo tokens. She has heard of Henry, who is a prominent Lagos based fashion blogger whom she wants to promote her bags. She then creates a smart contract with Henry whereby he gets paid in Yo tokens in exchange for ensuring that A-list celebrities are photographed carrying her bags. Henry is very successful in promoting Afua's bags and now has amassed a number of Yo tokens and wants to convert some to Bitcoins to pay a friend who is not on the same mobile phone network so he can simply exchange his tokens for bitcoins. He also wants to pay for repairs to his home and

needs to convert to a conventional currency, in this case USD (these conventional currencies are termed FIAT currencies). So he can simply execute the conversion on one of the new digital exchanges. The point of the above example is that the possibilities are endless and the tokenisation of the world as we know it will become reality.

Another example in the real world is when a farmer in Africa has a crop which he wishes to sell and he doesn't have a bank account but he has a smart phone. Consequently he can use an app on the phone to exchange part of his crop for fertiliser for the next season.

This process is much faster and efficient than a conventional bank transfer but clearly there is a major assumption in that the farmer owns a smartphone and is in an area with a cellular signal. As there is a significant dispersion amongst the African population amongst farms and small villages it means that only 43% of Africans can get a 3G data signal, and just 16% can get one offering fast (4G) mobile broadband. The costs of downloading data are also higher in Africa than in most other parts of the world. Of the ten countries with the highest fixed-broadband costs in the world, seven are in Africa.

They include landlocked Uganda, Rwanda and Burundi. Poverty also compounds the problem whereby the mobile phone operators are reluctant to invest in infrastructure. But on the positive side the cost of connecting Africa to the internet is anticipated to fall sharply. New cables grid the continent, increasing competition and driving down costs. Firms such as Google are installing fibre networks in cities such as Accra and Kampala in a bid to drive down the costs of data - simultaneously, satellites are being refined too. So with technology infrastructure rapidly improving there are high hopes for African businesses to gain access to digital-currency. To conclude, the very nascent nature of the African business landscape and infrastructure allow for a very exciting glimpse in to the near future whereby tokenisation and trading of such tokens will make business far more efficient, robust and secure for Africa.



Written by Bobby Console-Verma



VICTORIA'S SECRET IS OUT

HERIETH PAUL TALKS EXCLUSIVELY WITH THE ESTATE

Who are your role models personally and professionally as an African woman in the global limelight?

I'm so inspired by all kinds of women, but my mom is my biggest inspiration. Every day she amazes me with her strength and work ethic

and I want to be just like her when I grew up.

Explain how you felt, the first time you walked the runway for Victoria Secret?

The first time I walked the Victoria's Secret runway was surreal, I felt so happy to be a

part of such an amazing show. However, the second time was even better, I was more confident and comfortable and so I feel like I gave it my all on the runway.

What defines beauty for you?

Beauty to me is being beautiful inside and out and having a kind heart.

What are your top 3 tips for keeping your svelte figure and great skin?

Drinking lots of water and limiting my cheat days, only allow a couple of cheat days a month.

How do you ensure that you stay true to yourself in an ever changing industry?

Coming from a strong and supportive family has helped me stay grounded in this industry. I'm so blessed to have fundamental values instilled in me from my parents.

In three words can you tell us what legacy you would like to leave for Africa?

I'm only 21 (laughs) I'm still trying to figure that out. Let's wait and see.

PICTURES OF HERIETH PAUL PHOTOGRAPHY BY SHANE SUBAN



SPEEDMASTER GREY SIDE OF THE MOON “METEORITE”

The modern OMEGA Moonwatch is revered by a new generation of wearers for its outstanding design and innovative thinking. The name itself suggests a deep space journey – a Moonwatch that has hurtled through meteorite showers on its way to the distant red planet Sedna. In doing so, it has combined the elements of these celestial inspirations.

The 44.25mm Speedmaster Grey Side of the Moon Meteorite introduces a number of new features to the Speedmaster collection. For example, this is the first time that a tachymeter scale has been created using OMEGA Ceragold™.

OMEGA Ceragold™ is a special way of decorating ceramic watch parts with 18K gold. In this instance, the 18K Sedna™ gold bezel is layered with a silicon nitride bezel ring. This is harder and lighter than ceramic, and is considered an important material in the future of OMEGA's watchmaking. The OMEGA Ceragold™ tachymeter scale has then been added.

The main feature of this watch is the highlight that everyone wants to talk about.

That is the incredible meteorite dial. On each timepiece, the dial has been made from a solid piece of extraterrestrial stone.

It is estimated that between 2000 and 5000 meteorites over 1kg fall to Earth every year. 75% of those disappear over the ocean or desert. Some, however, are discovered and prized for their rare beauty. For Omega's Meteorite dial, we have sourced slices of the Gibeon meteorite that fell in prehistoric times in Namibia.

The local Nama people once used it to craft tools and weapons. More recently however, the allure of this iron meteorite has been prized by designers for its classic Widmanstätten pattern and for the owner of this watch, the pattern is clearly visible, and also unique in each model. The OMEGA Co-Axial calibre 9300 continues to sit at the watch's heart.

With the Speedmaster's connection to space, we believe that this timepiece is another remarkable tribute to the collection's past, and as close as it gets to owning a true secret of the universe.



Mappin & Webb

LONDON



33 mm. Case in 18K pink gold. 18K pink gold fluted crown set with a blue sapphire cabochon. Sapphire crystal. Lacquered silvered opaline flinqué dial. 12 Roman numerals. Sword-shaped blued-steel hands. Semi-mat brown alligator-skin strap. 18K pink gold ardillon buckle. Self-winding mechanical movement.



Eleven diamond set hour indices on the silver engine turned dial give the stainless steel Austen Round a heightened touch of style and glamour when partnered with the classic blued steel Breguet style hands. The elegantly understated lugs hold a black genuine crocodile strap, which is secured by an ardillon buckle, whilst the high quality Swiss quartz movement assures the modern woman that she will always be on time.

Mappin & Webb has been a cornerstone of English high society for over 240 years, and has an undisputed reputation for excellence in the craftsmanship of silverware and fine jewellery.

Granted a Royal Warrant by Her Majesty Queen Victoria in 1897, the Company has held a Royal Warrant to each succeeding monarch and currently holds appointments as 'Jewellers, Goldsmiths and Silversmiths' to Her Majesty The Queen and 'Silversmiths' to His Royal Highness The Prince of Wales.

Renowned for combining extraordinary

craftsmanship, exquisite materials and contemporary design, Mappin & Webb produces everything from fine jewellery and watches, to elegant silverware, glassware and bespoke lifestyle accessories.

In 2012, Mappin & Webb's master craftsman was appointed Crown Jeweller, custodian of the Crown Jewels of Her Majesty The Queen, the greatest honour that can be bestowed upon a jeweller.

Mappin & Webb has 14 boutiques throughout the British Isles including the original store at 132 Regent Street, London.



TAIBOBACAR

Taibo Bacar talks exclusively with The Estate

What is the most important feature about your brand?

The most important feature of our brand is the respect we have for the final consumer, that is, any product or any piece that is designed to our customers, takes into consideration certain aspects such as comfort and the life quality of the final consumer.

What has been pivotal to your brands global rise to success?

Above all, the personal connection with the people we have met throughout the years in this journey, whether they have been clients, potential investors, or people that can teach us whatever it is in order for us to evolve. People that enrich us through information, technology, etc. Also all the people that make the Taibo Bacar brand, I am talking about the employees, our team ... Everything depends on this team, from the tailor to the final consumer and our clients.

Have you always known that you would be a person of influence in Africa, Europe and the US?

No, because I never worried about that. I always say that all the good fruits are reaped when its tree is well sown and well treated. In this case, for us it was (and it is still) fundamental to treat our tree according to our principles, the work itself is our triumph and not what we can acquire from it. Obviously, we are conscious that we want credit and we want to profit from it as well but for us, delivering exceptional work is more important and was always the main priority. When we think about work, we do not focus on that, we focus on solving daily problems that are faced in the work space, improving them and delivering greatness.

What are some of the core values that your collections stand for?

Above of all, comfort and quality which represents respect for the final consumer, respect for what is our DNA with regards to serving women. We have ascertained ascertained the DNA for the ideal woman for Taibo Bacar, we always have her on mind in regards to what this woman needs to be a successful woman, and when I say successful, it could be professionally or personally.

So I believe that the respect we have for the Taibo Bacar woman, makes all the difference to our brand.

Who is the most significant person that has worn one of your designs and what impact did this experience have on you as an African designer?

With no doubt, the most influential and important woman that has worn our brand is my partner Tatiana Ismael. For the simple fact that of all of the people that I could mention, she is the one that I am 100% sure believes in our products and is the one that works tirelessly to make sure that our brand expands and is the one who make sure that the brand experiences growth.

So when Tatiana wears our brand it is to be praised because it means that she actually believes in this brand, she puts herself in a position of a consumer by exposing herself to the product because the product from Taibo Bacar is worth it.

Who is your role model and why?

All the youngsters that just like me have a purpose in life and have a goal to achieve and do everything possible to do so. In this sense, those who have a professional purpose but are always aware and respectful of their own personal purpose, making everything possible to achieve success without having to jeopardize others' success.



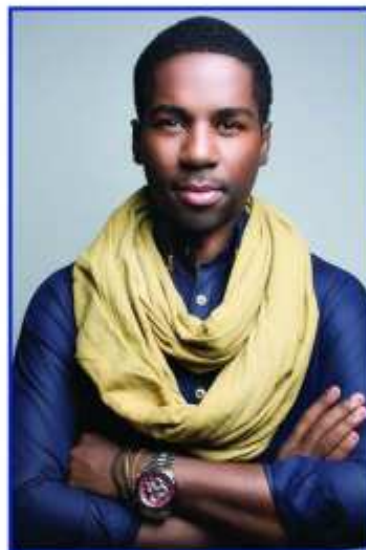
TAIBOBACAR



Talk us through the inspiration behind your latest collection?

A special collection without a doubt, a collection with so much simplicity and so much happiness from the heart. I decided to tell a story, not of a woman herself but how I see that woman, and how she affects my life experiences. It is a story about women that I have met throughout my journey, women that have something to add to my own story and to moments that will be remarkable in my life. It is special because it involves names of special women not only for me but for the people that are special to me. Again with no shadow of a doubt it is a special and wonderful collection because its story is told in a diary form and in each page and each chapter of this diary I can tell a little bit of a story of a woman that once crossed my path.

What are some key milestones you would still like to achieve?



There are so many levels that I would like to see the brand reach, but I can tell you that the brand has already reached many aspects that was once just a thought. For example, we would like to continue to progress and produce more and more, we would

like to have our products available throughout the world, we want the consumer to have easy access to our products globally. We want to have resellers and our own stores available in different cities throughout the 7 continents. We have a concrete plan for the evolution of our brand and this is what we work towards day by day.

In three words, can you tell us what legacy you would like to leave for Africa?

Luxury, Identity, Truth.

BRAVIG

LOCAL CONTENT : GLOBAL RELEVANCE



AFRICA & THE CARIBBEAN | LIMITLESS POTENTIAL
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「LIFESTYLE」



ARTWORK: COCO FLOWERS | ARTIST: BRADLEY THEODORE

GEM-SETTING IN MANY HUES

Rolex is introducing a gem-set version of the Oyster Perpetual Yacht-Master 40, its emblematic nautical watch. In 18 ct Everose gold with a black gloss finish dial, it features a bidirectional rotatable bezel adorned with multicolour sapphires, green tsavorites, and a triangular diamond at 12 o'clock. This version is equipped with the innovative, elastomer Oysterflex bracelet developed and patented by Rolex. Like all Rolex watches, the new Yacht-Master 40 carries the Superlative Chronometer certification redefined by Rolex in 2015, which ensures singular performance on the wrist.

Its characteristically shaped middle case is crafted from a solid block of 18 ct Everose gold. Its fluted case back is hermetically screwed down with a special tool that allows only Rolex watchmakers to access the movement. The winding crown is protected by a crown guard that is an integral part of the middle case. Fitted with the Triplock triple waterproofness system, the crown screws down securely against the case, providing watertight security akin to a submarine's hatch. The crystal, with a Cyclops lens at 3 o'clock for easy reading of the date, is made of virtually scratchproof sapphire. The waterproof Oyster case provides optimum protection for the Yacht-Master 40's high-precision movement.

Precise and reliable, the Yacht-Master 40 embodies the privileged ties between Rolex and the world of sailing that stretch back to the 1950s



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EPARA

AN EVENING WITH LAUREN VON DER POOL

HOSTED BY JOSEPH FARODOYE FOR
EPG MEDIA | THE ESTATE,
XQUISITUS AND ROSANNA UK
AT THE ROSANNA FLAGSHIP STORE
17 DUKE STREET LONDON, UK





THE HOUSE OF ITO

Setsu & Shinobu Ito, Italy's leading designers talk exclusively with Joseph Farodoye

Why did you choose to become furniture designers?

We are designers with broad work experience in architecture, interior & space, surface, product, industrial and package design.

Since our base is Milan, Italy, we do have a lot of experience in furniture design.

Furniture is one of the most historical items in human history, so we are not really influenced from the movement of trends as with other product designs, we look beyond current periods because good furniture lives a long time.

This is what we find the most attractive about furniture design and the reason why in Italy, so many international designers work in this area, and at same time this makes it the most difficult part of furniture design, because your designs are competing with all of the others, from history to up-to-date designs.

What makes your style unique?

From our "Bilingual" cultural experiences between Eastern and Western, since we are

originally Japanese with a strong philosophy influenced from nature. Our culture's principle is "Nature first" because we believe that everything starts from nature.

But at same time we are strongly influenced by what we believe is the European principle of "Human first", represented by more humanity and symbolic design languages.

What is the inspiration behind your design?

Most of the time our inspiration comes from nature. When we travel we are often greatly influenced from beautiful natural scenery, animals, fish, corals, forests & jungles and so on. Sometimes it is the smallest point of views to the largest.

How do you stay relevant whilst maintaining the style that you have become known for?

We do not stick to one style, we are always moving, travelling between nature, society and our imagination.

What makes design special for you?

When people discover in their daily lives new uses for our designs.

What is your most proud moment as designers?

When we hear someone giving us compliments on our designs without knowing who designed it.

What is your proudest piece of work/project to date?

Our proudest moments are always when we launch new pieces, although we have not produced our proudest piece yet. Our hope is always that our next future piece is our proudest.

What do you love most about being designers?

We can think and work anywhere at any time with only a pencil and one piece of paper.

What were some of the biggest challenges you faced in your career?

Some of most challenging projects have included a hotel resort masterplan & architectural design project, private jet interior project, and robotics product design project - All of these projects have still not been realised.

What advice would you give to a budding designer with hopes of making it in your industry?

Design should go beyond disciplinary boundaries, as business categories are changing in our society, design categories are also changing. Future designers should be very flexible and not specialise in one category of design.

Tell us about your latest designs

- Ily_I - One of our recent project of intelligent furniture design.
- IoT Mobility arm chair with sensor with automatic control, health control and communication system. We believe that one of the important directions of robotics will be the furniture robot. Robots actually give us more fear than peace but furniture lives with us for a long long time and this gives us peace. This project is a starting point of furniture robotics and has indicated a new direction for us.

In three words can you sum up the legacy you would like the Setsu & Shinobu Ito brand to leave?

Nature
Interactive
Beyond



setsu & shinobu ito



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J É S Û - S É G U N

L O N D O N

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HANDMADE Italian shoes are part of a lineage of Italian design and fashion folklore that has existed for decades. From soft handmade leather, to the subtle detailed embroidery associated with Italian shoe making and the exotic shapes used, Italy has always been associated with great style.

This is where bespoke shoe designer Jesu Segun has changed the status quo and disrupted the mould. The brand emerged from Westminster, London, UK as the brain child of Andrew McKenzie, a British born Nigerian. Receiving his training in Milan, the fashion capital of Italy, the brand once established quickly developed a devoted international following and celebrity client base. The style of shoe represents a contrast to the current landscape of shoe designs currently available.

Celebrity actors, sporting personalities and politicians have begun patronising the Nigerian inspired handmade Italian shoes. Legendary Ghanaian footballer and humanitarian Stephen Appah, has become an active ambassador for the brand explaining that "Historically Africans have always been master craftsmen and women, it's now time to showcase this globally".

The golden emblem that sits in the centre of the Jesu Segun brand is a symbol of female strength. It depicts a Nigerian warrior Queen, known throughout Africa as Iyoba Idia and embodies the very spirit of the brand. Jesu Segun is the epitome of African heritage and Black excellence and has become a major talking point for many who have taken an interest in the brand.

